

Android KitKat Smartphones: A Treat For All

Buying a phone has a lot to do with its OS, but it is not the only criteria. A powerful processor, high-definition screen and a powerful camera are equally important. If they were not, Motorola would have easily become the market leader in the last six months

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When the Android operating system was introduced, it was meant to provide advanced functionality with cheaper phones. But no manufacturer, except Motorola, seems to have paid heed to this. With the KitKat (Android 4.4) update, now Google promises a lot, including the fact that KitKat would work well in any phone with 512MB or more RAM. It means you should be able to buy a cheaper phone with the latest OS (cue Moto E).

So, when it comes to buying a KitKat phone, it really is a matter of value for money. In other words, the best KitKat phone for you should depend on the money you are willing to spend. The KitKat OS may work well even in cheaper phones, but a faster processor and other features could make the phone much better.

High-end smartphones

Flagships like the HTC One (M8), Sony Xperia Z2, LG Google Nexus 5 and the market leader (in terms of units sold)



Samsung Galaxy S5 cost at a hefty sum of ₹ 45,000 or more (with the exception of Nexus 5). But to see their value for money, you have to take their features into consideration.

Almost all the phones in this range have heavily layered versions of the OS. HTC gives you its Sense user interface (UI), which in our opinion is the best OEM-provided UI in the market. Samsung offers Touchwiz, and then there are others.

But if it's the pure Android experience you want, you should be looking at only Nexus 5, which sports a full-HD 12.6cm (4.95-inch) screen. In

addition, it has a powerful 2.3GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 800 processor and the pure un-layered version of the KitKat OS. This was the phone that Google had launched with KitKat and till date it remains one of the best KitKat devices to buy. It is also available at a very affordable price (for this range of smartphones) of ₹ 33,000.

The down side with Nexus 5 though is that, with Google's Android Silver project, this phone is rumoured to have gone out of production. Besides, Nexus 5 lacks a high-end camera. While KitKat makes it attractive, its 8-megapixel camera would not be

ANDROID KITKAT SMARTPHONES TO CHOOSE FROM

HTC One (M8)	Samsung Galaxy S5	Sony Xperia Z2	Moto G	Moto E
				
Price: ₹ 49,900	Price: ₹ 51,500	Price: ₹ 49,990	Price: ₹ 13,999	Price: ₹ 6999
➤ Camera: 4-Ultrapixel ➤ OS: Sense UI on Android 4.4.2 ➤ Display: Full HD ➤ Processor: 2.3GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 801	➤ Camera: 16-megapixel ➤ OS: Touchwiz on Android 4.4.2 ➤ Display: Super AMOLED, 16 million colours ➤ Processor: Exynos 6 octa-core	➤ Camera: 20.7-megapixel with 4k video ➤ OS: Android 4.4.2 ➤ Display: Full HD Triluminous display ➤ Processor: 2.5GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 801	➤ Camera: 5-megapixel ➤ OS: Pure Android 4.4.2 ➤ Display: 720-pixel HD display ➤ Processor: 1.2GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 400	➤ Camera: 5-megapixel ➤ OS: Pure Android 4.4.2 ➤ Display: qHD display ➤ Processor: 1.2GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 200